database system, please refer to the official documentation: https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/ef/core/providers/.

When you use an ORM like EF Core, the differences between database systems are more or less entirely hidden away from the application itself. The C# code you write for data storage and retrieval for one database system will work exactly the same against another system. The only real difference between one system and another is in initial configuration. I have chosen to feature two database systems in this book: a version of SQL Server, for Windows-only developers, and SQLite, for readers who want to follow along on other operating systems. I will highlight the rare differences between them as they arise.

Working in the Microsoft world, you are more likely to encounter their flagship relational database system, SQL Server, than any other option. A version of SQL Server, LocalDB, can be installed very easily when you install Visual Studio. It is not designed for production use and only includes the minimum set of files required to run an SQL Server database. For this reason, I have selected LocalDB as the edition to use for readers who want to work with Windows.

Any databases you create with LocalDB can also be used with the full version of SQL Server. Visual Studio includes a feature known as Server Explorer that enables you to connect to databases from within the IDE and perform basic database management tasks, such as modifying the tables and running queries. Alternatively, you can download and install SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS) free of charge (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sql/ssms/download-sql-server-management-studio-ssms?view=sql-server-ver16). SSMS is a much more powerful tool that includes features for managing databases, profiling query performance, and administering SQL Server installations.